

Chrome OS coming

Acer to launch the first Chrome OS products at Computex in Taiwan

A costly affair

The new 35mm f1.4 lens from Leica costs around \$5000, which is way more than some cars!

Razer Destructor

The fine art of aiding destruction

Specifications

Fractal texture; 350 mm (Length) x 280 (Width) x 2.3 mm (Height), non-slip rubber base

Contact

Razer

Web site:

www.razerzone.com

Price: Rs. 2,599

8/10

Features.....	8
Performance.....	8.5
Build.....	8.5
Value.....	6.5

Razer is known for making gamers happy, and the Destructor seems like a worthy attempt. It's a deviation from the soft, cloth-based, foam-backed surfaces we're used to seeing. Instead the Destructor has a hard surface that has just enough texture to be termed as "unsmooth". In fact the texture is similar to very fine sandpaper – although it's not abrasive to your fingertips. There is a thin layer of soft rubber on the rear side of the hard surface, and this provides excellent grip – the mat will not slide on the table, no matter how hard you try. The mat ships in a fancy, rigid zipper case that should

easily protect it from most wear and tear.

While testing we couldn't help but notice how wide this mat is – great for gaming, where mouse movements are erratic and sudden and the travel distance is a lot. Tracking is very, very accurate, and this is not something limited to Razer mice. We found even Logitech's MX 518 and G500 gaming mice tracked wonderfully on this surface, although coming from a cloth-weave-based gaming mat you'll need to adjust to the relatively



higher acceleration and slightly lower initial resistance that the surface provides. Accuracy is not sacrificed over speed making the Destructor a truly killer prospect for the competition. The surface is easier to clean than cloth weaves – a nice plus. It's well suited to FPS games and RPGs alike.

Logitech G13

The gamers handful!

The name initially struck as being weird – all other Logitech G series keyboards are full size – the G13 is what they call a "game board". Immediately, the impeccable build strikes you – the bold moniker on the rear is metallic, and the plastic used is of the highest quality. The black/silver/grey build suits its audience well. The palm/wrist rest is pretty luxurious. Though it's not soft there is a soft rubber finish that is comfortable. This material doesn't get slick with sweat and provides sufficient grip as well as takes stress off the wrist. 25 programmable macro keys have been provided and the rather

ergonomic small joystick that is operated using your thumb also supports macro functionality.

The wave-like design of the G13 and the key positioning is perfectly ergonomic and we could find no complaint. When using it with games, you will need to use the inbuilt driver to profile each game you have installed, and map keys properly before the G13 shows its mettle. Even then, the learning curve for migrating to this game board isn't easy, initially we found our Warcraft 3 skills lagging, as it takes several hours to get used to the non-conventional layout. Once you do get used to it, the



G13 grows on you, and besides being a stylish addition to your desktop, is a great boon for gamers. The backlighting and LCD HUD adds a lot of style. It's not cheap though, at Rs. 4,245, it's certainly not for everyone.

Specifications

Macro keys: 25 keys; LCD display; joystick with mouse buttons, backlit keys and display.

Contact

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logitech.com

Web site: www.logitech.com

Price: Rs. 4,245

7/10

Build Quality.....	8
Features.....	8
Performance.....	8.5
Value for money.....	5